PRODUCTION BOOK · CHARACTERS + 5-SECOND BEATS

POV: You're 40 and You Work for Your Younger Brother



— Nobody at the company knows you own 24%

10	183	9	~15 min
CHARACTERS	BEATS	CHAPTERS	RUNTIME

Interactive: tap any link to jump, tick the boxes, type notes. Use your PDF app's bookmarks panel to navigate. Best in Adobe Acrobat Reader, Foxit, Xodo or a desktop browser so the boxes and notes save.

How to use this book

This book works in **two steps**. Every blue word is a link: tap it to jump. The dark bar at the top of every page has **Chapter overview** and **Cast** buttons, and your PDF app's **bookmarks panel** lists every chapter and character.

STEP 1 · Build your cast. Generate one reference image for each character using the character prompts. Save the images and tick **Reference made**. Attach these references when generating beats so faces stay consistent.

STEP 2 · Generate the beats. Work chapter by chapter from the chapter overview. Each beat is one image on screen, about **5 seconds** of narration. Timecodes are estimated at about 155 words per minute (the Michael voice pace). Copy the image prompt, generate, and tick **Image**, **Animated** and **Placed** as you go. Use the notes box at the start of each chapter for anything you want to remember.

In the edit: drop each image at its timecode, or set every image to 5 seconds. The beats average 5.0s, so the timeline stays in sync with the voiceover. Add a slow push-in or pan to every image.

Locked visual style

flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail.

Outfit and lighting by chapter

CHAPTERS	OUTFIT	LIGHTING
1, 4–6, 8 · At Routewise (age 36–40)	Black quarter-zip + OPERATIONS badge	Cool office or warehouse light
2–3 · The bank years (age 28–35)	Black crewneck over white shirt and navy tie	Warm muted flashback / soft daylight
7 · Visiting Dad (age 39)	Black quarter-zip	Warm kitchen lamp, fading
9 · The Toast (age 40)	Dark tailored jacket over black tee	Warm golden dining light

Recurring visual motifs

The folded check stub ($38,000) in his wallet · the OPERATIONS badge · the white paper coffee cup · Danny's 30 Under 30 magazine page under yellowing tape on the refrigerator · the gravy boat at the sink · the orange extension cord in the garage · the desk by the supply closet · Dad's question: “When are you going to build something of your own?”

STEP 1 OF 2

Build your cast

Generate these reference images before any beat.

10 characters
Tick each one when its reference is saved

CHARACTER	ROLE	APPEARS IN	
The Protagonist	Main character · ages 28–40	105 beats	☐ Reference made
Danny	Younger brother · founder, age 34	40 beats	☐ Reference made
Young Danny	Age 22 · the garage years	10 beats	☐ Reference made
Dad	Their father · grows frail	31 beats	☐ Reference made
Tyler	Vice president · age 29	13 beats	☐ Reference made
Kelsey	Danny's wife	3 beats	☐ Reference made
The New Hire	Whispers in the back row	3 beats	☐ Reference made
The Whispering Coworker	"Danny gave him a job."	2 beats	☐ Reference made
The Lawyer	High-school friend	2 beats	☐ Reference made
The Client	Holiday party	2 beats	☐ Reference made

The Protagonist

MAIN CHARACTER · AGES 28–40



☐ Reference made

CHARACTER PROMPT

Character reference sheet of the protagonist: a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan. Show him four times side by side, full body front view, same face and hair in every pose, deadpan expression: (1) age 28 in a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and navy tie, (2) black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, holding a white paper coffee cup, (3) black quarter-zip without the badge, (4) dark tailored jacket over a black tee. Plain light-gray background, outfit labels under each pose. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)

1, 2, 5, 6, 7, 10, 11, 12, 13, 14, 15, 18, 19, 20, 21, 22, 23, 24, 26, 28, 29, 30, 36, 40, 41, 43, 45, 46, 48, 50, 51, 52, 54, 56, 60, 61, 63, 64, 65, 66 ... +65 more

Danny

YOUNGER BROTHER · FOUNDER, AGE 34

☐ Reference made

CHARACTER PROMPT

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Danny, age 34: a slim, energetic man with styled light-brown hair and a confident, practiced grin, wearing a gray vest over a white tee, slim dark jeans and spotless white sneakers, a smartwatch on his wrist. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)

3, 4, 7, 8, 9, 18, 54, 55, 57, 58, 62, 71, 72, 87, 89, 94, 95, 96, 97, 100, 101, 103, 104, 119, 125, 132, 142, 143, 146, 154, 155, 156, 157, 158, 160, 165, 168, 169, 170, 179

Young Danny
AGE 22 · THE GARAGE YEARS

☐ Reference made

CHARACTER PROMPT
Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Young Danny, age 22: a lanky young man with messy light-brown hair and an eager, restless grin, wearing a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers, holding a laptop. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)
31, 32, 33, 36, 39, 40, 46, 47, 49, 50

Dad
THEIR FATHER · GROWS FRAIL

☐ Reference made

CHARACTER PROMPT
Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Their father, shown twice side by side: (1) in his late fifties, sturdy, thinning gray hair, wire glasses, brown cardigan over a plaid shirt, a reserved proud expression; (2) in his early seventies, frail and thinner, a cardigan too big for him, trembling hands, a tired gentle expression. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)
18, 29, 30, 32, 49, 52, 53, 59, 62, 63, 64, 65, 66, 67, 124, 125, 127, 129, 130, 133, 134, 136, 164, 165, 166, 171, 172, 173, 174, 175, 177

Tyler
VICE PRESIDENT · AGE 29

☐ Reference made

CHARACTER PROMPT
Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Tyler, age 29: a confident young executive with slicked-back dark-blond hair and a smug smile, wearing a gray fleece vest with a small ROUTEWISE logo over a light-blue button-down, chinos and wireless earbuds, holding a coffee. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)
77, 78, 79, 80, 81, 82, 96, 120, 144, 147, 148, 149, 150

Kelsey
DANNY'S WIFE

☐ Reference made

CHARACTER PROMPT
Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. Kelsey, Danny's wife: a polished woman in her thirties with a sleek blonde bob and a warm but practiced smile, wearing an elegant emerald dress and pearl earrings, holding a glass of wine. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)
18, 89, 90

The New Hire
WHISPERS IN THE BACK ROW

☐ Reference made

CHARACTER PROMPT
Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. The new hire: a young man in his early twenties with curly brown hair and a curious face, wearing a green crewneck sweater, khakis and a company lanyard. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)
11, 12, 153

The Whispering Coworker

"DANNY GAVE HIM A JOB."

☐ Reference made

CHARACTER PROMPT

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. A coworker in her twenties with a dark high ponytail and a knowing smirk, wearing a mustard blazer over a black top and a company lanyard. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)

11, 12

The Lawyer

HIGH-SCHOOL FRIEND

☐ Reference made

CHARACTER PROMPT

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. The lawyer: a man in his late twenties, a high-school friend, short dark hair, rumpled gray suit and loosened tie, holding a fountain pen and a contract. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)

43, 45

The Client

HOLIDAY PARTY

☐ Reference made

CHARACTER PROMPT

Character reference sheet, full body, front view and three-quarter view side by side, neutral standing pose, plain light-gray background, consistent proportions. The client: a middle-aged businessman with neat silver hair and a sympathetic expression, wearing a navy suit and red tie. Flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, semi-chibi proportions with an oversized head.

APPEARS IN BEATS (tap to jump)

89, 91

STEP 2 OF 2

Generate the beats

Tap a chapter to jump straight to it.

183 beats · ~5s each
00:00 – 15:19

CHAPTER	TITLE	BEATS	TIME	
1	**The All-Hands** Age 40 · "Danny gave him a job."	1–23 23 beats	00:00–02:00	☐ Chapter done
2	**The Check** Age 28 · $38,400 and one condition	24–53 30 beats	02:00–04:31	☐ Chapter done
3	**The Smart One** Ages 29–35 · The page on the refrigerator	54–68 15 beats	04:31–05:45	☐ Chapter done
4	**Operations** Age 36 · The desk by the supply closet	69–93 25 beats	05:45–07:49	☐ Chapter done
5	**The Story He Believes** Age 37 · "Sometimes I forget it wasn't all me."	94–104 11 beats	07:49–08:47	☐ Chapter done
6	**The Year It Almost Disappears** Age 38 · Your hand on the boardroom door	105–122 18 beats	08:47–10:08	☐ Chapter done
7	**The Refrigerator** Age 39 · "Soon, Dad."	123–138 16 beats	10:08–11:34	☐ Chapter done
8	**Twenty-Four Percent** Age 40 · The ownership table	139–162 24 beats	11:34–13:35	☐ Chapter done
9	**The Toast** Age 40 · "You just let your brother hold it."	163–183 21 beats	13:35–15:19	☐ Chapter done

CHAPTER 1 OF 9

The All-Hands

Age 40 · "Danny gave him a job."

Beats 1–23 · 23 images
00:00 – 02:00

CHAPTER NOTES

001
BEAT

00:00
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"It's 8:15 on a Monday morning, and you're standing at the back of a converted warehouse"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
Wide view of a converted brick warehouse office at 8:15 in the morning, rows of folding chairs filling with employees, the protagonist standing alone at the very back wall. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide establishing shot from the back. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: quiet, isolated.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide establishing shot from the back	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	quiet, isolated	leaning against the back wall

002
BEAT

00:06
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"with a coffee in a paper cup. Two hundred people sit in rows of folding chairs."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist at the back holding a white paper coffee cup, two hundred employees seated in folding chairs facing a stage. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot, protagonist off-center left. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: detached.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot, protagonist off-center left	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	detached	holding the coffee

003
BEAT

00:12
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Up front, under a banner that says ROUTEWISE, your little brother adjusts a microphone."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
A small stage under a large banner reading "ROUTEWISE", Danny adjusting a microphone stand, employees looking up at him. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: low-angle medium shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: corporate, expectant.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
low-angle medium shot	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	corporate, expectant	tapping the microphone

004
BEAT

00:17
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Danny is thirty-four. Gray vest. White sneakers that cost more than your first car."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Close view of Danny on stage in a gray vest and spotless white sneakers, a confident grin, spotlight on him. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium close-up on Danny. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: polished, charismatic.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium close-up on Danny	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	polished, charismatic	smiling at the crowd

005
BEAT

00:23
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You are forty. Your badge says Operations. Not Director. Not Head of. Just Operations."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of a lanyard badge on the protagonist's chest reading only "OPERATIONS", his deadpan face above it. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: diminished.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	diminished	the badge hanging still

006
BEAT

00:28
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Somebody printed it wrong two years ago, and nobody ever fixed it.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist looking down at his badge, a crossed-out printed title visible faintly beneath "OPERATIONS". The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: small, overlooked.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	small, overlooked	glancing at the badge

007
BEAT

00:33
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Danny starts the story. You know it by heart. Everyone here does.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny on stage mid-speech with an open palm, the crowd leaning in, the protagonist mouthing the words silently at the back. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: rehearsed, ironic.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	rehearsed, ironic	mouthing along

008
BEAT

00:38
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“The garage. The two laptops. The extension cord running from the kitchen.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
A nostalgic glowing projection on the screen behind Danny showing a cluttered garage with two laptops on a folding table and an orange extension cord. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on the screen. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: mythologized.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot on the screen	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	mythologized	the photo glowing on screen

009
BEAT

00:42
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Twelve years ago, he says, I had nothing. No money. No investors."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny on stage pressing a hand to his chest, a slide reading "12 YEARS AGO: NOTHING", employees nodding. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: dramatic, self-made.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	dramatic, self-made	hand on chest

010
BEAT

00:47
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Nobody who believed in me. I built this alone. Two hundred people clap."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The crowd of two hundred employees applauding enthusiastically while the protagonist stands motionless at the back. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot from behind the crowd. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: hollow, isolating.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot from behind the crowd	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	hollow, isolating	everyone clapping except him

011
BEAT

00:52
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"A new hire in the row in front of you leans toward the woman beside him."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist · The New Hire · The Whispering Coworker

IMAGE PROMPT
A young new hire with curly hair and a lanyard leaning toward a young woman beside him in the back row, the protagonist just behind them. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the new hire is a young man in his early twenties with curly brown hair, a green sweater and a company lanyard; the young woman is a coworker in her twenties with a dark ponytail, a mustard blazer and a lanyard. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: over-the-shoulder shot from behind the protagonist. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: gossipy.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
over-the-shoulder shot from behind the protagonist	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	gossipy	leaning in to whisper

012
BEAT

00:58
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Who's the guy in the back? he whispers. That's his brother, she whispers back."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist · The New Hire · The Whispering Coworker

IMAGE PROMPT
The young woman whispering back with a knowing smirk while the curly-haired new hire glances back at the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the new hire is a young man in his early twenties with curly brown hair, a green sweater and a company lanyard; the young woman is a coworker in her twenties with a dark ponytail, a mustard blazer and a lanyard. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: condescending.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	condescending	whispering

013
BEAT

01:04
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Danny gave him a job. You sip your coffee. It's cold already."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist taking a sip from the paper coffee cup, steam no longer rising, his face expressionless. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: stoic.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	stoic	sipping cold coffee

014
BEAT

01:08
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"In your wallet, behind your license, there's a piece of paper folded into a square"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of a worn leather wallet open in the protagonist's hand, a tiny folded paper square tucked behind his driver's license. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: secret.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
extreme close-up insert	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	secret	pulling the wallet open

015
BEAT

01:14
4.3s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“so small it's gone soft at the edges. A check stub.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The tiny folded paper square, soft and frayed at the edges, resting in the protagonist's fingertips. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: precious, hidden.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
extreme close-up insert	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	precious, hidden	holding the square

016
BEAT

01:18
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Twelve years old. Pay to the order of Routewise LLC. Thirty-eight thousand dollars.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
An unfolded old check stub reading "Pay to the order of ROUTEWISE LLC — $38,000.00", yellowed and creased. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: revealing.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
extreme close-up insert	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	revealing	the stub lit softly

017
BEAT

01:23
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Nobody in this room knows it exists. Not the new hires. Not the board.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
The crowd of employees and a row of board members in suits seated near the stage, each with a small question-mark icon above their heads. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: oblivious.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	oblivious	everyone facing the stage

018
BEAT

01:29
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Not Danny's wife. Not your father. Only Danny. And some days, you're not sure he remembers.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist · Danny · Dad · Kelsey

IMAGE PROMPT
Split image of Danny's wife Kelsey at a party and the protagonist's elderly father at a kitchen table, both unaware, with Danny on stage in the center looking briefly at the back of the room. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers; his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years; Kelsey is a polished woman in her thirties with a sleek blonde bob, pearl earrings and an elegant emerald dress. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: three-panel split. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: secret, uncertain.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
three-panel split	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	secret, uncertain	Danny's eyes flicking to his brother

019
BEAT

01:35
4.3s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Here's what nobody tells you about working for your younger brother.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist alone in a pool of light at the back of the warehouse while the crowd blurs. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with shallow focus. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: introspective.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot with shallow focus	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	introspective	standing still

020
BEAT

01:39
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“The hard part isn't taking orders. It's watching everyone decide who you are,”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist surrounded by faint floating labels like "charity case", "the brother" and "helps out" drifting around his head. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical medium shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: judged.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
metaphorical medium shot	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	judged	ignoring the labels

021
BEAT

01:44
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“and deciding not to correct them. This is how the brother everyone pitied turned out”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist calmly zipping his lips with two fingers while the labels swirl. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: restrained.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	restrained	zipping his lips

022
BEAT

01:50
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“to own almost a quarter of the company. And why he kept quiet for twelve years,”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
A large pie chart hovering over the warehouse with a slice labeled "24%" glowing gold behind the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical wide shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: hidden power.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
metaphorical wide shot	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	hidden power	the slice glowing

023
BEAT

01:56
3.5s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“even when it cost him everything except the money.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist walking away down a long empty office hallway, small and alone. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide one-point-perspective shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front. Mood: lonely cost.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide one-point-perspective shot	cool industrial daylight from high warehouse windows with warm stage lights at the front	lonely cost	walking away

CHAPTER 2 OF 9

The Check

Age 28 · $38,400 and one condition

Beats 24–53 · 30 images
02:00 – 04:31

CHAPTER NOTES

024
BEAT

02:00
5.0s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"Twelve years earlier, you're twenty-eight, sitting in a bank branch on Fulton Avenue"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
A younger protagonist at age twenty-eight sitting behind a desk in a small bank branch, a nameplate on the door reading "Assistant Manager". The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot, desaturated warm tint. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: steady, modest.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot, desaturated warm tint	warm muted flashback light	steady, modest	sitting upright

025
BEAT

02:05
4.3s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"with your name on the door. Assistant manager. $61,000 a year."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A nameplate on the bank office door and a pay stub on the desk reading "$61,000 / year". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: modest pride.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	warm muted flashback light	modest pride	the nameplate catching light

026
BEAT

02:09
5.0s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"You've been saving for a house since you were twenty-four. Every month, $800."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The younger protagonist at home at a small kitchen table updating a savings jar labeled "HOUSE" and a bank statement showing "$800 deposit". The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: disciplined.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	warm muted flashback light	disciplined	dropping money in the jar

027
BEAT

02:14
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"No vacations. No new car. The savings account is up to $38,400."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A bank app on a phone showing "Savings: $38,400" next to crossed-out flyers for vacations and a car dealership. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: sacrifice.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	warm muted flashback light	sacrifice	thumb on the balance

028
BEAT

02:19
3.5s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"One more year, and you'll have a down payment."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The younger protagonist looking at a printed listing of a small starter house with a "DOWN PAYMENT" note circled. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up over his shoulder. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: hopeful.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up over his shoulder	warm muted flashback light	hopeful	holding the listing

029
BEAT

02:22
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Your father is proud of you in the way he's proud of things"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father at a family table nodding approvingly at the younger protagonist in his bank tie. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: reserved pride.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm muted flashback light	reserved pride	a firm nod

030
BEAT

02:27
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“that don't surprise him. You were the steady one. The one who finished things.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father patting the younger protagonist's shoulder like checking a box, a small checkmark icon above. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: predictable approval.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm muted flashback light	predictable approval	a pat on the shoulder

031
BEAT

02:33
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Danny was the other one. Danny dropped out of college after three semesters. A band.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Young Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Young Danny at twenty-two with messy hair holding a dropout notice and an electric guitar, grinning carelessly. Character notes: young Danny is a lanky twenty-two-year-old with messy light-brown hair, a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on young Danny. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: reckless, charming.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot on young Danny	warm muted flashback light	reckless, charming	shrugging

032
BEAT

02:39
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“A food truck. A golf app. Your father called every one of them the same thing.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Young Danny Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
A montage of young Danny's failed projects: a band poster, a food truck sketch, a golf app on a phone, all stamped "HOBBY" by his father's hand. Character notes: young Danny is a lanky twenty-two-year-old with messy light-brown hair, a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers; his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: three-panel montage. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: dismissive.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
three-panel montage	warm muted flashback light	dismissive	the stamp coming down

033
BEAT

02:45
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Another one of Danny's hobbies. That spring, Danny is twenty-two and living in your parents' garage."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Young Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
A cluttered suburban garage converted into a workspace, young Danny hunched over a laptop at night. Character notes: young Danny is a lanky twenty-two-year-old with messy light-brown hair, a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: warm bare-bulb garage light. Mood: scrappy, determined.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	warm bare-bulb garage light	scrappy, determined	typing intensely

034
BEAT

02:51
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Two laptops on a folding table. An extension cord running under the kitchen door."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
Two laptops on a folding table with an orange extension cord snaking under a kitchen door into the garage. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm bare-bulb garage light. Mood: humble beginnings.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	warm bare-bulb garage light	humble beginnings	the cord running across the floor

035
BEAT

02:57
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"He's building software that tells small delivery companies the fastest route for every driver,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A laptop screen showing a city map with colored delivery routes and small van icons. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm bare-bulb garage light. Mood: clever.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	warm bare-bulb garage light	clever	routes animating on screen

036
BEAT

03:02
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"every morning. He shows it to you on a Sunday."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist · Young Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Young Danny turning his laptop toward the younger protagonist on a Sunday afternoon in the garage. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: young Danny is a lanky twenty-two-year-old with messy light-brown hair, a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm bare-bulb garage light. Mood: eager.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm bare-bulb garage light	eager	showing the screen

037
BEAT

03:06
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"A bakery across town already pays him $200 a month for it."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A bakery owner in an apron holding a tablet showing the route app, a "$200/month" invoice on the counter. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: validating.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	soft clean daylight	validating	the baker smiling at the tablet

038
BEAT

03:11
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Then a flower shop. Then a pharmacy. He needs servers."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
Three small shop signs side by side — a bakery, a flower shop, a pharmacy — each with a tiny route app logo on the window. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide montage shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: growing.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide montage shot	soft clean daylight	growing	signs lighting up one by one

039
BEAT

03:14
4.3s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"A developer. Six months of rent somewhere that isn't a garage."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Young Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Young Danny pointing at a whiteboard listing "SERVERS · DEVELOPER · 6 MONTHS RENT" in messy marker. Character notes: young Danny is a lanky twenty-two-year-old with messy light-brown hair, a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm bare-bulb garage light. Mood: ambitious, strapped.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	warm bare-bulb garage light	ambitious, strapped	tapping the whiteboard

040
BEAT

03:19
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"He doesn't ask you for money. He asks you what you think he should do."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist · Young Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Young Danny sitting on an overturned bucket looking up at the younger protagonist for advice. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: young Danny is a lanky twenty-two-year-old with messy light-brown hair, a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm bare-bulb garage light. Mood: vulnerable trust.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm bare-bulb garage light	vulnerable trust	asking quietly

041
BEAT

03:25
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You drive home and look at your savings account for a long time."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The younger protagonist sitting in his parked car at night staring at a phone banking app. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot inside the car. Lighting: cool night streetlight. Mood: heavy decision.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot inside the car	cool night streetlight	heavy decision	staring at the screen

042
BEAT

03:30
4.3s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"$38,400. Four years of saying no to things. The next week,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of a phone screen reading "$38,400" with four years of calendar pages fanning behind it. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: cool night streetlight. Mood: weighty.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	cool night streetlight	weighty	the number glowing

043
BEAT

03:34
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“a lawyer you went to high school with draws up a simple paper.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist The Lawyer

IMAGE PROMPT
A cramped lawyer's office, a lawyer in his late twenties in a rumpled suit drafting a simple contract across from the younger protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the lawyer is a man in his late twenties with short dark hair, a rumpled gray suit and loosened tie. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm desk lamp light. Mood: serious.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm desk lamp light	serious	pen to paper

044
BEAT

03:39
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Thirty-eight thousand dollars for thirty percent of Routewise. He asks if you're sure.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of the contract reading "$38,000 for 30% of ROUTEWISE LLC". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm desk lamp light. Mood: binding.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	warm desk lamp light	binding	the clause visible

045
BEAT

03:44
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“You say yes before he finishes the sentence. Then you add one condition.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist The Lawyer

IMAGE PROMPT
The younger protagonist nodding firmly before the lawyer finishes speaking, then raising one finger. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the lawyer is a man in his late twenties with short dark hair, a rumpled gray suit and loosened tie. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm desk lamp light. Mood: resolute.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	warm desk lamp light	resolute	raising one finger

046
BEAT

03:49
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Not in the paperwork. Just between you and Danny. Nobody knows. Not Dad. Not anyone.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist · Young Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
The younger protagonist and young Danny face to face in the garage, the protagonist holding a finger to his lips. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: young Danny is a lanky twenty-two-year-old with messy light-brown hair, a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm bare-bulb garage light. Mood: secret pact.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm bare-bulb garage light	secret pact	finger to lips

047
BEAT

03:55
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Out loud, it's always yours. Danny looks at you like you've lost your mind.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Young Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Young Danny staring at his brother in disbelief, eyebrows raised high. Character notes: young Danny is a lanky twenty-two-year-old with messy light-brown hair, a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on young Danny. Lighting: warm bare-bulb garage light. Mood: confused.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on young Danny	warm bare-bulb garage light	confused	staring

048
BEAT

04:00
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Why? You don't explain. You can't say it out loud.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The younger protagonist looking away silently, jaw set, unable to explain. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: warm bare-bulb garage light. Mood: unspoken.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up	warm bare-bulb garage light	unspoken	turning away

049
BEAT

04:04
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"That your father has called him a hobby for six years. That just once,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Young Danny · Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
A faded flashback inset of their father waving dismissively at young Danny's guitar, the word "HOBBY" hanging in the air. Character notes: young Danny is a lanky twenty-two-year-old with messy light-brown hair, a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers; his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with flashback overlay. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: painful memory.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot with flashback overlay	warm muted flashback light	painful memory	the dismissive wave

050
BEAT

04:10
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"you want Danny to have something nobody can take credit for. He signs."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist · Young Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Young Danny signing the contract on the folding table, the younger protagonist watching. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: young Danny is a lanky twenty-two-year-old with messy light-brown hair, a faded band hoodie, ripped jeans and worn sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on hands. Lighting: warm bare-bulb garage light. Mood: momentous.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on hands	warm bare-bulb garage light	momentous	pen moving

051
BEAT

04:15
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You sign. You write the check at your kitchen table. Your hand doesn't shake."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The younger protagonist writing a check for $38,000 at a small kitchen table with a steady hand. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up on the check. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: calm, committed.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
extreme close-up on the check	warm kitchen lamp light	calm, committed	signing the check

052
BEAT

04:20
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You tell your father you decided to wait on the house. Market's too high,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
The younger protagonist talking to his father in the family living room, his father in an armchair. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, at age twenty-eight, clean-cut, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: deceptive calm.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm muted flashback light	deceptive calm	explaining casually

053
BEAT

04:26
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"you say. He nods. Smart, he says. You were always the smart one."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father nodding approvingly and tapping his own temple, a small "SMART" speech bubble. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium close-up on father. Lighting: warm muted flashback light. Mood: ironic approval.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium close-up on father	warm muted flashback light	ironic approval	tapping his temple

CHAPTER 3 OF 9

The Smart One

Ages 29–35 · The page on the refrigerator

Beats 54–68 · 15 images
04:31 – 05:45

CHAPTER NOTES

054
BEAT

04:31
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Then come the years where it looks like Danny is the smart one."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **The Protagonist** **Danny**

IMAGE PROMPT

A seesaw tipping as Danny rises on one end and the protagonist sinks quietly on the other. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical medium shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight. Mood: shifting status.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
metaphorical medium shot	soft warm daylight	shifting status	the seesaw tilting

055
BEAT

04:36
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Routewise gets an office. Then investors. Every round, your thirty percent shrinks."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT **Danny**

IMAGE PROMPT

A bright new startup office with a "ROUTEWISE" sign, investors shaking Danny's hand. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight. Mood: growth.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot	soft warm daylight	growth	handshakes

056
BEAT

04:40
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Twenty-eight. Twenty-six. Twenty-four. The slice gets smaller. The pie gets much bigger."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
A pie chart where the protagonist's slice shrinks from 30% to 28%, 26%, 24% while the whole pie grows larger. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical close-up. Lighting: soft warm daylight. Mood: dilution, growth.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
metaphorical close-up	soft warm daylight	dilution, growth	the slice shrinking

057
BEAT

04:45
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"By the time Danny is twenty-nine, a business magazine puts him on a list."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
A glossy business magazine on a newsstand with Danny on the cover. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft warm daylight. Mood: prestigious.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	soft warm daylight	prestigious	the magazine on the rack

058
BEAT

04:50
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Thirty Under Thirty. There's a photo of him in front of a wall of screens,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
A magazine page titled "30 UNDER 30" with Danny posing arms crossed in front of a wall of glowing screens. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft warm daylight. Mood: triumphant.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	soft warm daylight	triumphant	the page displayed

059
BEAT

04:56
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"arms crossed. Your father cuts it out and puts it on the refrigerator."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father carefully taping the magazine page onto the family refrigerator. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: proud.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	warm kitchen lamp light	proud	pressing tape on the corners

060
BEAT

05:01
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“It stays there for five years. The tape turns yellow. You're still at the bank.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The same refrigerator years later, the tape on the magazine page yellowed, the protagonist in a bank tie glancing at it. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: stagnant.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	warm kitchen lamp light	stagnant	glancing at the fridge

061
BEAT

05:07
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“A promotion. Then another one. $84,000. It's a good job. Nobody frames it.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist at a bank desk receiving a promotion letter reading "$84,000", nobody around to notice. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool office light. Mood: quietly unseen.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	flat cool office light	quietly unseen	reading the letter

062
BEAT

05:12
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“At Thanksgiving, your father raises a glass. To Danny, he says. Who proved everybody wrong.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
A Thanksgiving dinner table, his father standing and raising a glass toward Danny. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers; his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: celebratory.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	warm golden dining light	celebratory	raising a glass

063
BEAT

05:18
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Everybody laughs, because everybody includes your father. Then he turns to you."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
The family laughing at the table, his father laughing loudest, the protagonist smiling politely. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: uncomfortable.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot	warm golden dining light	uncomfortable	everyone laughing

064
BEAT

05:23
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Still at the bank, Mark? Still holding the fort? You say yes."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father turning toward the protagonist with a friendly but condescending smile, a speech bubble reading "Still at the bank?". The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: patronizing.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm golden dining light	patronizing	turning to him

065
BEAT

05:27
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You pass the stuffing. Later, in the kitchen, he puts a hand on your shoulder"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist passing a bowl of stuffing, then later standing in the kitchen with his father's hand on his shoulder. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: tender, heavy.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm kitchen lamp light	tender, heavy	the hand on his shoulder

066
BEAT

05:33
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“and asks the question he'll ask you for the next ten years.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father looking into the protagonist's eyes in the dim kitchen, about to speak. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on father. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: earnest worry.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on father	warm kitchen lamp light	earnest worry	leaning in

067
BEAT

05:38
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“When are you going to build something of your own?”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of his father's speech bubble reading "When are you going to build something of your own?". Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: recurring wound.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	warm kitchen lamp light	recurring wound	the bubble appearing

068
BEAT

05:42
3.1s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“You don't answer. You wash the gravy boat.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist silently washing a gravy boat at the kitchen sink. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black crewneck sweater over a white collared shirt and a navy tie, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot from the side. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: avoidant, quiet.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot from the side	warm kitchen lamp light	avoidant, quiet	scrubbing the gravy boat

CHAPTER 4 OF 9

Operations

Age 36 · The desk by the supply closet

Beats 69–93 · 25 images
05:45 – 07:49

CHAPTER NOTES

069
BEAT

05:45
6.2s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"When you're thirty-six, the bank merges with a bigger bank. Your branch closes on a Friday."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A bank branch with a "CLOSED — MERGED" sign on the glass door on a Friday afternoon. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide exterior shot. Lighting: cool overcast daylight. Mood: abrupt ending.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide exterior shot	cool overcast daylight	abrupt ending	the sign hanging

070
BEAT

05:51
4.3s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"They give you a box, a cake from the grocery store,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist holding a cardboard box of desk items and a small grocery-store sheet cake. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: cool overcast daylight. Mood: deflated.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	cool overcast daylight	deflated	holding the box

071
BEAT

05:55
5.4s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"and eleven weeks of severance. Two weeks later, Danny calls. Come work with us,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist at his kitchen table answering a phone call from Danny, a severance letter beside him. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: surprised.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	soft clean daylight	surprised	answering the phone

072
BEAT

06:01
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"he says. We need someone who actually knows how to run things."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Split screen of Danny on the phone in a glass office and the protagonist listening at home. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: split-screen medium shots. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: tempting offer.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
split-screen medium shots	soft clean daylight	tempting offer	Danny gesturing confidently

073
BEAT

06:05
3.5s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You should say no. You know how it'll look."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist hesitating with the phone to his ear, staring at the severance letter. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: reluctant.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up	soft clean daylight	reluctant	pausing

074
BEAT

06:09
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You say yes anyway, because the severance runs out in nine weeks,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A calendar on the wall with nine weeks circled in red ending at "SEVERANCE ENDS". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: pressured.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	soft clean daylight	pressured	the red circle

075
BEAT

06:13
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"and because some part of you wants to see it. The thing you paid for."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist walking into the bright Routewise office for the first time, eyes on the ROUTEWISE logo. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: curious, bittersweet.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	curious, bittersweet	stepping inside

076
BEAT

06:19
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Your title is Director of Operations. Your salary is $78,000."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
An offer letter on a desk reading "Director of Operations — $78,000". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: modest.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	flat cool office fluorescent light	modest	the letter on the desk

077
BEAT

06:23
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Less than the bank. You report to a vice president named Tyler."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Tyler, a young vice president, extending a handshake to the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: awkward hierarchy.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	awkward hierarchy	shaking hands

078
BEAT

06:28
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Tyler is twenty-nine. Tyler wears a fleece vest with the company logo"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Tyler in a fleece company vest with a coffee in hand, talking confidently. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on Tyler. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: smug.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot on Tyler	flat cool office fluorescent light	smug	gesturing with the coffee

079
BEAT

06:33
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"and says circle back the way other people breathe. On your first day,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Tyler leading the protagonist through the open office past rows of desks. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium tracking-style shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: uncomfortable.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium tracking-style shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	uncomfortable	walking through the office

080
BEAT

06:38
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Tyler walks you to a desk by the supply closet. Danny speaks very highly of you,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
A small cramped desk wedged beside a supply closet door, Tyler gesturing toward it. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: demeaning.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	demeaning	pointing at the desk

081
BEAT

06:44
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“he says. Then he smiles in a way that tells you exactly what Danny said.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Tyler giving the protagonist a fake, knowing smile. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on Tyler. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: condescending.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on Tyler	flat cool office fluorescent light	condescending	smiling knowingly

082
BEAT

06:50
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Be nice to him. He's family. You learn fast what that means.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Tyler patting the protagonist's shoulder patronizingly, a speech bubble reading "He's family". The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: patronizing.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	patronizing	the pat

083
BEAT

06:54
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“It means meetings you hear about after they happen. The problems nobody else wants.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist at his supply-closet desk looking through glass at a meeting already in progress without him. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot through glass. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: excluded.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot through glass	flat cool office fluorescent light	excluded	watching the meeting

084
BEAT

07:00
3.5s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"The server outage at 2:40 on a Sunday morning,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist alone in a dark office at 2:40 a.m. with server alerts flashing red on multiple monitors. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: cold blue monitor glow in a dark office. Mood: urgent, alone.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	cold blue monitor glow in a dark office	urgent, alone	typing fast

085
BEAT

07:03
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"when you're the only one who picks up the phone."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of a phone screen showing "Incoming call: 2:40 AM — SERVER DOWN" in the protagonist's hand. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: cold blue monitor glow in a dark office. Mood: alarming.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	cold blue monitor glow in a dark office	alarming	answering

086
BEAT

07:07
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You fix the outage by 5. You go home and sleep for three hours."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist leaning back in his chair at dawn, monitors now green, exhausted. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: cool dawn light through office windows. Mood: drained victory.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	cool dawn light through office windows	drained victory	rubbing his eyes

087
BEAT

07:13
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"On Monday, Danny posts about it online. Proud of this team for pulling together under pressure."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
A social media post on a phone from Danny reading "Proud of this team for pulling together under pressure!". Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: ironic.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	flat cool office fluorescent light	ironic	the post appearing

088
BEAT

07:19
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Four hundred likes. He doesn't mention your name. Nobody notices it's missing."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The post with "400 likes" and no mention of the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: erased.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	flat cool office fluorescent light	erased	the likes counting up

089
BEAT

07:23
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"At the company holiday party, Danny's wife, Kelsey, introduces you to a client."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny Kelsey The Client

IMAGE PROMPT
A company holiday party with string lights, Kelsey, Danny's wife, presenting the protagonist to a well-dressed client. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers; Kelsey is a polished woman in her thirties with a sleek blonde bob, pearl earrings and an elegant emerald dress; the client is a middle-aged businessman with silver hair in a navy suit. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium three-shot. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: social.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium three-shot	warm party lighting	social	Kelsey gesturing toward him

090
BEAT

07:28
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“This is Danny's older brother, she says, warmly. He helps out with operations. Helps out.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Kelsey

IMAGE PROMPT
Kelsey smiling warmly while speaking, a small speech bubble reading "He helps out". Character notes: Kelsey is a polished woman in her thirties with a sleek blonde bob, pearl earrings and an elegant emerald dress. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on Kelsey. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: diminishing.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on Kelsey	warm party lighting	diminishing	smiling

091
BEAT

07:34
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“The client shakes your hand the way people shake hands at a funeral.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist The Client

IMAGE PROMPT
The client shaking the protagonist's hand with a sympathetic, funeral-like expression. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the client is a middle-aged businessman with silver hair in a navy suit. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: pitying.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm party lighting	pitying	the handshake

092
BEAT

07:39
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“You could end it with one sentence. You know exactly which one.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist with his mouth closed, one unspoken sentence glowing faintly inside a thought bubble. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: warm party lighting. Mood: tempted.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up	warm party lighting	tempted	holding back

093
BEAT

07:44
5.4s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

> *"You refill the coffee and walk back to your desk by the supply closet."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist refilling a paper coffee cup in the break room and walking back to his supply-closet desk. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: resigned.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	resigned	walking away

CHAPTER 5 OF 9

The Story He Believes

Age 37 · "Sometimes I forget it wasn't all me."

Beats 94–104 · 11 images
07:49 – 08:47

CHAPTER NOTES

094
BEAT

07:49
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"The worst part isn't the people who think you're a charity case. It's Danny."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist · Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny in the bright office surrounded by admiring employees, the protagonist in the background. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: painful focus.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	painful focus	Danny laughing

095
BEAT

07:55
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Because somewhere in the last six years, Danny started believing the story too."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny looking at his own reflection in a glass wall, the reflection showing him alone in a garage. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical medium shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: self-deception.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
metaphorical medium shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	self-deception	staring at himself

096
BEAT

08:00
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You see it in small things. The way he asks you, in front of Tyler,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist · Danny · Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny in front of Tyler casually handing the protagonist a lunch order list. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers; Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium three-shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: humiliating.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium three-shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	humiliating	handing the list

097
BEAT

08:06
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"to grab the lunch order. The way he tells the garage story at conferences"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny on a conference stage in front of a big screen showing a garage photo. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool stage lighting. Mood: performative.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	cool stage lighting	performative	presenting

098
BEAT

08:11
3.1s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"and the extension cord gets longer every time,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
The orange extension cord on the conference screen stretching longer and longer across the stage in a comic exaggeration. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: metaphorical wide shot. Lighting: cool stage lighting. Mood: ironic.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
metaphorical wide shot	cool stage lighting	ironic	the cord stretching

099
BEAT

08:14
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"and the number of people who believed in him stays at zero."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A slide on the screen reading "PEOPLE WHO BELIEVED IN ME: 0". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: cool stage lighting. Mood: erasing.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	cool stage lighting	erasing	the zero glowing

100
BEAT
08:19
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“One night, you find him alone in the glass conference room. You okay?”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny sitting alone at night in a glass conference room, the protagonist at the door. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot through glass. Lighting: dim office at night with cool monitor glow. Mood: quiet, intimate.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot through glass	dim office at night with cool monitor glow	quiet, intimate	knocking softly

101
BEAT
08:24
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“you ask. He doesn't look up. Do you ever think about it? he says.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny not looking up from the table, speaking quietly. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on Danny. Lighting: dim office at night with cool monitor glow. Mood: guilty.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on Danny	dim office at night with cool monitor glow	guilty	staring at the table

102
BEAT
08:29
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“The check? Every day, you want to say. Sometimes, you say instead. He nods.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist answering with a calm face while a thought bubble shows the check stub. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: dim office at night with cool monitor glow. Mood: restrained.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	dim office at night with cool monitor glow	restrained	answering

103
BEAT

08:35
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Then he says something you'll replay for years. Sometimes I forget it wasn't all me.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny looking up at the protagonist with a troubled, honest expression. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on Danny. Lighting: dim office at night with cool monitor glow. Mood: confessional.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on Danny	dim office at night with cool monitor glow	confessional	meeting his eyes

104
BEAT

08:41
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Is that bad? You tell him to go home. You turn off the lights behind him.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist switching off the conference room lights while Danny walks out. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: dim office at night with cool monitor glow. Mood: protective.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	dim office at night with cool monitor glow	protective	flipping the switch

CHAPTER 6 OF 9

The Year It Almost Disappears

Age 38 · Your hand on the boardroom door

Beats 105–122 · 18 images
08:47 – 10:08

CHAPTER NOTES

105
BEAT

08:47
3.1s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Then comes the year it almost all disappears."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
The Routewise office darkened with a storm cloud forming over the ROUTEWISE logo. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide metaphorical shot. Lighting: dim cold light. Mood: ominous.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide metaphorical shot	dim cold light	ominous	the cloud gathering

106
BEAT

08:50
3.5s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You're thirty-eight. A competitor cuts its prices in half."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A rival company's billboard reading "50% OFF" towering over the Routewise office. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool overcast daylight. Mood: threatening.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	cool overcast daylight	threatening	the billboard glowing

107
BEAT

08:53
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Two of the biggest clients leave in the same month."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
Two client logos being removed from a "CLIENTS" wall in the office. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: loss.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	loss	logos coming down

108
BEAT

08:57
3.5s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"The cash runway shrinks from eighteen months to three."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A runway chart on a monitor dropping from "18 MONTHS" to "3 MONTHS" in red. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: alarming.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	flat cool office fluorescent light	alarming	the bar shrinking

109
BEAT

09:01
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"In a board meeting you're not invited to, an investor suggests selling for parts."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A closed boardroom with investors in suits around a table, a slide reading "SELL FOR PARTS". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot through glass. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: cold, calculating.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot through glass	flat cool office fluorescent light	cold, calculating	investors nodding

110
BEAT

09:06
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Twelve million dollars. Enough to pay back the investors. Nothing for anyone else."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A slide showing "$12,000,000 — investors repaid, others: $0". Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: ruthless.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	flat cool office fluorescent light	ruthless	the zero highlighted

111
BEAT

09:11
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You read the minutes the next morning. Your twenty-four percent of nothing is nothing."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist at his desk reading meeting minutes, a "24% × 0 = 0" note scribbled beside him. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up over his shoulder. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: grim.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up over his shoulder	flat cool office fluorescent light	grim	reading the minutes

112
BEAT

09:17
3.5s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"That's the closest you ever come to saying it."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist walking slowly down a hallway toward the boardroom. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium tracking-style shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: tense.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium tracking-style shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	tense	walking

113
BEAT

09:20
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You stand outside the boardroom with your hand on the door. You're a shareholder."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist's hand resting on the boardroom door handle, voices visible through frosted glass. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: tempting power.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	flat cool office fluorescent light	tempting power	gripping the handle

114
BEAT

09:26
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"One sentence, and every person who ever called you a charity case would know."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
A thought bubble above the protagonist showing every employee turning in shock. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with thought bubble. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: imagined reveal.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot with thought bubble	flat cool office fluorescent light	imagined reveal	hesitating

115
BEAT
09:31
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You let go of the door handle. Instead, you call every client who left."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist releasing the door handle and turning to his desk phone. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: resolute restraint.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	resolute restraint	letting go

116
BEAT
09:37
4.3s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You drive to their offices. You sit in their waiting rooms."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist sitting in a client's waiting room with a folder on his knees. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: humble, persistent.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	soft clean daylight	humble, persistent	waiting patiently

117
BEAT
09:41
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You fix the things nobody fixed. It takes four months."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist fixing a client's delivery dashboard on a laptop beside a grateful client. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: soft clean daylight. Mood: diligent.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	soft clean daylight	diligent	typing

118
BEAT
09:45
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You win both back. Then a third you never had. The company survives."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
Client logos being placed back on the "CLIENTS" wall, plus a new one. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: recovery.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	recovery	logos going back up

119
BEAT
09:50
4.3s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"At the next all-hands, Danny thanks the whole team for believing."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny at an all-hands raising both arms to thank the cheering team. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight. Mood: celebratory.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	cool industrial daylight	celebratory	arms raised

120
BEAT
09:54
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Tyler gets a bonus. You get a new badge. It still says Operations."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Tyler holding a bonus check while the protagonist receives a new lanyard badge still reading "OPERATIONS". The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight. Mood: ironic.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	cool industrial daylight	ironic	holding up items

121
BEAT
09:59
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Something changes in you that year. You stop checking what the company is worth."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist closing a valuation app on his phone without looking. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on hands. Lighting: soft warm daylight. Mood: detached, free.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on hands	soft warm daylight	detached, free	closing the app

122
BEAT

10:05
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“The number becomes something you own. Not something you are.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist walking out of the office calmly into daylight. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: soft warm daylight. Mood: at peace.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot	soft warm daylight	at peace	walking out

CHAPTER 7 OF 9

The Refrigerator

Age 39 · "Soon, Dad."

Beats 123–138 · 16 images
10:08 – 11:34

CHAPTER NOTES

123
BEAT

10:08
5.0s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"And around that time, the cost starts showing up somewhere you didn't expect."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A gray storm cloud drifting toward a modest family house. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide establishing shot. Lighting: cool overcast daylight. Mood: foreboding.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide establishing shot	cool overcast daylight	foreboding	the cloud moving in

124
BEAT

10:13
4.3s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"Your father gets sick. Slowly, the way old men get sick."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father, now older and frail, sitting in an armchair with a blanket and a pill organizer. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: fragile.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	fragile	resting in the chair

125
BEAT

10:18
4.7s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"His hands shake. He forgets words. Danny visits on Sundays, between flights."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of his father's trembling hands holding a teacup, Danny on a phone screen on a video call from an airport. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers; his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: split close-up. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: distant care.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
split close-up	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	distant care	the teacup shaking

126
BEAT

10:22
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You visit every Tuesday and Thursday. Nobody at the office notices when you leave."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist leaving the office mid-afternoon with his jacket, colleagues not looking up. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: unnoticed devotion.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	unnoticed devotion	walking out

127
BEAT

10:28
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"One Thursday, your father is sitting at the kitchen table,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father sitting alone at the kitchen table in a quiet house. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: lonely.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	lonely	sitting still

128
BEAT

10:32
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"staring at the magazine page on the refrigerator. The yellow tape is peeling at one corner."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
The yellowed magazine page on the refrigerator with one corner of tape peeling off. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: fading pride.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	fading pride	the corner curling

129
BEAT
10:38
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"I worry about you, he says. Not Danny. Danny's going to be fine. But you."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father looking at the protagonist across the kitchen table with worried eyes. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on father. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: tender worry.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on father	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	tender worry	speaking softly

130
BEAT
10:44
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You put your whole life into other people's things. The bank. Your brother."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father gesturing gently toward the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: concerned.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	concerned	reaching out a hand

131
BEAT
10:49
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"When are you going to build something of your own? You look at the photo."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
The recurring speech bubble "When are you going to build something of your own?" over the kitchen table. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: recurring wound.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	recurring wound	the bubble appearing

132
BEAT

10:55
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“At the arms crossed. At the wall of screens your thirty-eight thousand dollars paid for.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of Danny's magazine photo with arms crossed in front of glowing screens, the protagonist's reflection faint in the glossy paper. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: bittersweet.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
extreme close-up insert	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	bittersweet	the reflection overlapping

133
BEAT

11:00
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“You almost tell him. But he's tired, and his hands are shaking,”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist opening his mouth to speak, his father looking tired and shaky across the table. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: hesitant.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	hesitant	almost speaking

134
BEAT

11:05
7.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“and he looks at that page on the refrigerator the way he never looked at anything you did.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father gazing proudly at the refrigerator page with glistening eyes. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on father. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: proud, fragile.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on father	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	proud, fragile	gazing at the page

135
BEAT

11:12
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"And you realize that if you tell him, you'd be taking it away from him too."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist's face, jaw set, choosing silence. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: tight close-up. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: sacrificial.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
tight close-up	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	sacrificial	closing his mouth

136
BEAT

11:18
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"The one story about his youngest son that ended the way he hoped."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father smiling at the magazine page, contentment softening his face. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on father. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: tender.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on father	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	tender	smiling

137
BEAT

11:23
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You tape the corner of the page back down. Soon, Dad, you say."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist pressing the peeling corner of tape back onto the refrigerator. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up on hands. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading. Mood: tender, silent.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
extreme close-up on hands	warm kitchen lamp light, soft and fading	tender, silent	smoothing the tape

138
BEAT

11:28
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“You hate yourself on the drive home. You also know you'd do it again.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT

The protagonist driving at night with a pained expression, streetlights streaking past. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot inside the car. Lighting: cool night streetlight. Mood: conflicted.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot inside the car	cool night streetlight	conflicted	gripping the wheel

CHAPTER 8 OF 9

Twenty-Four Percent

Age 40 · The ownership table

Beats 139–162 · 24 images
11:34 – 13:35

CHAPTER NOTES

139
BEAT

11:34
4.3s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"Which brings you back to the warehouse. The all-hands. The banner."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
The converted warehouse all-hands again, the ROUTEWISE banner and folding chairs. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide establishing shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high windows with warm stage lights. Mood: full circle.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide establishing shot	cool industrial daylight from high windows with warm stage lights	full circle	the crowd seated

140
BEAT

11:38
3.9s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"The cold coffee in the paper cup. Three weeks ago,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist at the back of the room holding the same white paper cup of cold coffee. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high windows with warm stage lights. Mood: recurring.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	cool industrial daylight from high windows with warm stage lights	recurring	holding the cup

141
BEAT

11:42
5.0s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"a national logistics company offered to buy Routewise. One hundred forty million dollars."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A slide on the stage screen reading "ACQUIRED — $140,000,000" with a logistics company logo. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high windows with warm stage lights. Mood: huge news.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	cool industrial daylight from high windows with warm stage lights	huge news	the slide appearing

142
BEAT
11:47
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"The papers were signed on Friday. Up front, Danny talks about the journey."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny speaking passionately on stage in front of the acquisition slide. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on Danny. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high windows with warm stage lights. Mood: triumphant.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot on Danny	cool industrial daylight from high windows with warm stage lights	triumphant	gesturing

143
BEAT
11:52
4.3s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"The vision. Then he says it again. I built this alone."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny on stage, hand on chest, the crowd mid-applause, the protagonist small at the back. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight from high windows with warm stage lights. Mood: repetitive irony.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	cool industrial daylight from high windows with warm stage lights	repetitive irony	hand on chest

144
BEAT
11:56
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"After the meeting, Tyler finds you by the coffee machine, holding a printout."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Tyler approaching the protagonist at a coffee machine holding a printed document. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: tense.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	tense	holding out the printout

145
BEAT

12:01
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"The buyer's lawyers sent the final ownership table. Every shareholder. Every percentage."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of the printout titled "FINAL OWNERSHIP TABLE" with rows of names and percentages. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: official.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	flat cool office fluorescent light	official	the table visible

146
BEAT

12:06
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Your name is the second line. Twenty-four percent. Right under Danny. Tyler looks at the paper."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of the second row on the ownership table showing the protagonist's name and "24%" highlighted, just under Danny's name. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: stunning.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
extreme close-up insert	flat cool office fluorescent light	stunning	the highlight

147
BEAT

12:12
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Then at you. Then at the paper again. You report to me, he says."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Tyler looking from the paper to the protagonist and back with wide eyes. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on Tyler. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: disbelief.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on Tyler	flat cool office fluorescent light	disbelief	looking back and forth

148
BEAT
12:18
5.4s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"It's not a question. It's a man trying to make the room make sense."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Tyler frozen, mouth slightly open, the office suddenly feeling very quiet around him. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on Tyler. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: stunned.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot on Tyler	flat cool office fluorescent light	stunned	standing frozen

149
BEAT
12:23
4.3s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"For four years, you say. He opens his mouth. Closes it."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist answering calmly while Tyler opens and closes his mouth. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: power shift.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	power shift	Tyler speechless

150
BEAT
12:27
6.2s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"Then he says the only thing he can think of. Do you want a better desk?"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Tyler

IMAGE PROMPT
Tyler awkwardly gesturing toward a corner office with a nervous smile. Character notes: Tyler is a twenty-nine-year-old with slicked-back hair, a gray fleece company vest over a button-down and wireless earbuds. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on Tyler. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: groveling.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot on Tyler	flat cool office fluorescent light	groveling	pointing at the corner office

151
BEAT
12:34
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You laugh. No, you say. I like the supply closet."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist laughing softly, shaking his head. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: light, liberated.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up	flat cool office fluorescent light	light, liberated	laughing

152
BEAT
12:38
4.3s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"It's quiet. By lunch, the whole building knows. The new hire"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
The open office buzzing as employees whisper and glance toward the supply-closet desk. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: gossip spreading.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	gossip spreading	heads turning

153
BEAT
12:42
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"who whispered in the back row brings you a coffee you didn't ask for."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist, The New Hire

IMAGE PROMPT
The curly-haired new hire nervously placing a fresh coffee on the protagonist's desk. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: the new hire is a young man in his early twenties with curly brown hair, a green sweater and a company lanyard. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: respectful, sheepish.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	respectful, sheepish	setting down the cup

154
BEAT
12:47
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You thank him. You mean it. That night, Danny finds you in the parking lot."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
A nearly empty office parking lot at night, Danny walking toward the protagonist's car. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: buzzing sodium lights at night. Mood: quiet confrontation.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	buzzing sodium lights at night	quiet confrontation	walking

155
BEAT
12:53
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"It's almost empty. The lights buzz. He's holding his car keys and not using them."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny standing under a buzzing parking lot light holding his car keys loosely. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on Danny. Lighting: buzzing sodium lights at night. Mood: uncertain.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot on Danny	buzzing sodium lights at night	uncertain	holding the keys

156
BEAT
12:59
4.3s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"I said it again, he says. Alone. In front of everyone."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny looking ashamed, eyes down. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on Danny. Lighting: buzzing sodium lights at night. Mood: guilty.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on Danny	buzzing sodium lights at night	guilty	looking down

157
BEAT

13:03
4.3s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“I know. I was there. Why didn't you ever stop me?”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist · Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist leaning against his car, calm, while Danny asks his question. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: buzzing sodium lights at night. Mood: honest.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	buzzing sodium lights at night	honest	leaning on the car

158
BEAT

13:07
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“he asks. Any day. Any meeting. You could have told them all.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny spreading his hands in frustration. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot on Danny. Lighting: buzzing sodium lights at night. Mood: pleading.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot on Danny	buzzing sodium lights at night	pleading	gesturing

159
BEAT

13:12
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“Because it was never mine to tell, you say. It was yours to say.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist speaking quietly with a gentle expression. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up. Lighting: buzzing sodium lights at night. Mood: wise, loving.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up	buzzing sodium lights at night	wise, loving	speaking

160
BEAT

13:18
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“He's quiet for a long time. Then he puts his keys back in his pocket.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny slowly sliding his car keys back into his pocket, staying. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on hands. Lighting: buzzing sodium lights at night. Mood: moved.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on hands	buzzing sodium lights at night	moved	pocketing the keys

161
BEAT

13:23
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"The wire hits your account on a Wednesday. More zeros than you ever let yourself picture."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A phone banking notification reading "Wire received" with a long blurred number of zeros. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: life-changing.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	flat cool office fluorescent light	life-changing	the notification glowing

162
BEAT

13:30
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"You read it twice. You go to work. Your badge still says Operations."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist at his supply-closet desk the next morning, badge still reading "OPERATIONS". The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a black quarter-zip pullover with a lanyard badge reading OPERATIONS, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: unchanged, grounded.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	flat cool office fluorescent light	unchanged, grounded	sitting down to work

CHAPTER 9 OF 9

The Toast

Age 40 · "You just let your brother hold it."

Beats 163–183 · 21 images
13:35 – 15:19

CHAPTER NOTES

163
BEAT

13:35
3.9s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"On Sunday, there's a family dinner at your father's house."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
Exterior of the modest family house at dusk with warm windows and cars in the driveway. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide establishing shot. Lighting: warm dusk light. Mood: warm, familial.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide establishing shot	warm dusk light	warm, familial	lights glowing inside

164
BEAT

13:39
5.4s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"He sits at the head of the table, smaller than he used to be."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father at the head of a dinner table looking small and frail in a cardigan. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: fragile, dignified.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	warm golden dining light	fragile, dignified	sitting quietly

165
BEAT

13:44
4.7s

☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"Before anyone eats, Danny stands up with a glass. Your father beams."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny standing with a glass raised, his father beaming. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers; his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium-wide shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: expectant.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium-wide shot	warm golden dining light	expectant	raising the glass

166
BEAT
13:49
3.9s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"He's heard this toast before. Twelve years ago, Danny says,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father nodding knowingly, the family listening. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: familiar.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	warm golden dining light	familiar	nodding

167
BEAT
13:53
4.7s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"I was in that garage with two laptops and an extension cord."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A faded flashback inset of the garage with two laptops and an extension cord above the dinner table. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot with flashback overlay. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: nostalgic.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot with flashback overlay	warm golden dining light	nostalgic	the memory glowing

168
BEAT
13:57
5.0s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"And everyone thinks I did it alone. He looks at you. I didn't."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Danny turning to look directly at the protagonist across the table. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a dark tailored jacket over a black tee, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: pivotal.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm golden dining light	pivotal	turning

169
BEAT
14:02
5.4s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"There was a check. Thirty-eight thousand dollars. It was supposed to be a house."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
Close-up of the old check stub "$38,000" held up by Danny. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: revealing.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	warm golden dining light	revealing	holding it up

170
BEAT
14:08
5.4s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"He tells all of it. The condition. The outage at 2:40 in the morning."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
The family listening in stunned silence as Danny speaks. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: shocked.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	warm golden dining light	shocked	frozen faces

171
BEAT
14:13
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"The four months of waiting rooms. Your father looks at you. Then at the refrigerator."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father looking from the protagonist to the refrigerator and back. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a dark tailored jacket over a black tee, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on father. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: realizing.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on father	warm golden dining light	realizing	eyes moving

172
BEAT
14:19
5.0s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Then back at you. His hand shakes when he reaches across the table,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father's trembling hand reaching across the table toward the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a dark tailored jacket over a black tee, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on hands. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: emotional.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on hands	warm golden dining light	emotional	reaching

173
BEAT
14:24
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“and you're not sure it's the illness. You never said, he says. No, you say.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father speaking softly with wet eyes, the protagonist answering quietly. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a dark tailored jacket over a black tee, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: tender.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm golden dining light	tender	speaking

174
BEAT
14:30
5.8s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“He holds your wrist for a long moment. You did build something of your own,”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father holding the protagonist's wrist across the table. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a dark tailored jacket over a black tee, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up on hands. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: reconciling.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
extreme close-up on hands	warm golden dining light	reconciling	holding the wrist

175
BEAT
14:36
3.9s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *“he says quietly. You just let your brother hold it.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father smiling through tears at the protagonist. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a dark tailored jacket over a black tee, and is the darkest value in the frame. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up on father. Lighting: warm golden dining light. Mood: redemptive.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up on father	warm golden dining light	redemptive	smiling

176
BEAT

14:39
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"After dinner, you wash the gravy boat, the way you always do."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist washing the gravy boat at the kitchen sink after dinner. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a dark tailored jacket over a black tee, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot from the side. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: peaceful ritual.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot from the side	warm kitchen lamp light	peaceful ritual	scrubbing

177
BEAT

14:44
6.2s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Your father takes the towel and dries. You take the check stub out of your wallet."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Dad

IMAGE PROMPT
His father beside him drying the gravy boat with a towel. Character notes: his father is a man in his late sixties with thinning gray hair, wire glasses and a brown cardigan, growing frailer over the years. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium two-shot. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: together, healed.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium two-shot	warm kitchen lamp light	together, healed	drying

178
BEAT

14:50
4.7s

- [ ] Image
- [ ] Animated
- [ ] Placed

> *"Twelve years, folded into a square. You unfold it, smooth it flat,"*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist unfolding the worn check stub and smoothing it flat on the counter. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a dark tailored jacket over a black tee, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up on hands. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: closure.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
extreme close-up on hands	warm kitchen lamp light	closure	smoothing the paper

179
BEAT
14:55
4.7s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"and tape it to the refrigerator, right next to the magazine page."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT Danny

IMAGE PROMPT
The check stub taped to the refrigerator beside Danny's yellowed magazine page. Character notes: Danny is a slim, energetic man in his mid-thirties with styled light-brown hair, a confident grin, a gray vest over a white tee and spotless white sneakers. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: recognition.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	warm kitchen lamp light	recognition	both papers side by side

180
BEAT
15:00
4.3s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"Here's what nobody tells you about working for your younger brother."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The protagonist standing in the warm kitchen doorway looking back at the refrigerator. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a dark tailored jacket over a black tee, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: medium shot. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: reflective.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
medium shot	warm kitchen lamp light	reflective	looking back

181
BEAT
15:04
3.9s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"People will measure you by your badge. By your desk."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
A lanyard badge reading "OPERATIONS" lying on a desk. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: close-up insert. Lighting: flat cool office fluorescent light. Mood: ironic.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
close-up insert	flat cool office fluorescent light	ironic	the badge resting

182
BEAT
15:08
5.4s
☐ Image
☐ Animated
☐ Placed

> *"By who stands at the front of the room. They'll get the math wrong."*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT The Protagonist

IMAGE PROMPT
The warehouse stage with an empty microphone and the banner, the protagonist's paper cup left on a chair at the back. The protagonist is a young man with an oversized head, messy curly jet-black hair, thick black rectangular glasses, heavy half-lidded tired eyes with faint dark under-eye lines, thick slightly furrowed black eyebrows, pale off-white skin and a small flat frowning mouth, always deadpan, wearing a dark tailored jacket over a black tee, and is the darkest value in the frame. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: wide shot. Lighting: cool industrial daylight. Mood: reframed.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
wide shot	cool industrial daylight	reframed	the cup sitting still

183
BEAT

15:13
5.4s

- ☐ Image
- ☐ Animated
- ☐ Placed

> *“And the people worth keeping are the ones who learn to say it right.”*

CHARACTERS IN THIS BEAT No characters (environment or insert shot)

IMAGE PROMPT
Final close-up of the refrigerator: magazine page and check stub side by side under warm light. Style: flat 2D cartoon webcomic illustration, bold clean black outlines, flat cel shading, desaturated slate-blue and gray palette with muted olive, rust, mustard and maroon accents, detailed lived-in background, semi-chibi characters with oversized heads, layered foreground, mid-ground and background, 16:9 frame with the bottom 15% kept clear of important detail. Camera: extreme close-up insert. Lighting: warm kitchen lamp light. Mood: final, tender.

CAMERA	LIGHTING	MOOD	ACTION
extreme close-up insert	warm kitchen lamp light	final, tender	the papers glowing